

Teagasc review

Changes - Farmer Platform

1. Add a monthly cash-flow budget

Add a simple monthly table showing expected cash coming in, cash going out and the resulting balance. Highlight months where the farm is expected to have a cash deficit or surplus.

- Right now focuses too much on annual results, month to month assessments recommended to spot financial pressure early

2. Add Actual vs Budget tracking

Allow the farmer or advisor to compare actual monthly cash receipts and payments against the original budget. Show the difference in euros and explain the main causes.

- Budget not as useful if actual results not compared -> allows to understand and control cashflows

3. Identify whether a cash-flow problem is short-term or long-term

When the platform identifies a cash shortage, classify it as:

- Short-term or once-off, such as a temporary price decrease, input-cost increase or weather event.
- Long-term or structural, such as consistently low profitability, high costs or excessive debt.

Include a short explanation of what is causing the classification.

- The correct response depends on the type of problem. A viable farm with a temporary shortage may require short-term funding, while a structural problem requires changes to costs, debt..etc

4. Expand the debt information:

Replace the single total debt figure with a debt register containing:

- Lender
- Outstanding balance
- Interest rate
- Years remaining
- Repayment amount and timing

- A total debt figure alone does not show the real repayment pressure. Need to understand who is owed, how much, what the debt costs and how long remains.

5. Separate farm and household cash movements

Create separate categories for:

- Farm income and expenditure
- Household drawings and living costs
- Off-farm income
- Tax
- Pensions and insurance
- Transfers between farm and household accounts

The platform can still show a combined cash position, but it should clearly identify where the pressure originates.

- Separate farm and household accounts essential for good cash management.

6. Add practical cash-flow action testing

Allow the advisor to test actions such as:

- Bringing forward sales
- Deferring purchases or expenditure
- Changing loan-repayment timing
- Matching large payments to months with cash surpluses
- Using short-term credit to cover temporary gaps

Show how each action changes the lowest cash balance and the number of deficit months.

- More useful for decision making

7. Add early cash-flow warnings

Create alerts for signs such as:

- Increasing overdraft use
- Increasing merchant or credit-card balances
- Insufficient cash for direct debits
- Future months with a negative cash balance
- Loan repayments falling in low-cash months

- Early warnings

8. Produce an advisor-ready cash-flow plan

Add a concise report containing:

- Current cash position
- Monthly cash-flow projection
- Expected deficit periods
- Debt commitments
- Main causes of financial pressure
- Agreed actions
- Updated position after those actions

- Teagasc recommends using realistic budgets and current cash-flow projections when working with advisors, suppliers and lenders.

UX review

1. Simplify the main navigation

Group overlapping pages into fewer sections, for example:

- Overview
- Cash Flow
- Farm Performance
- Action Plan
- Farm Data

- Similar information appears across sections: overwhelming

2. Make the Dashboard more focused

Show only the most important information:

- Current cash position
- Lowest projected cash balance
- Month with the lowest cash balance
- Projected annual surplus or deficit
- Main financial concern
- Recommended next action

- Too many figures currently

3. Clarify the period represented by each figure

Label every result clearly as:

- Historical Actual
- Trailing 12 Months
- Current-Year Budget
- Forecast
- Scenario Result

Include the exact start and end dates.

- Right now information is mixed- period

4. Remove contradictory messages

Make sure the health score, risk rating, alerts and written explanations are all based on the same financial results.

5. Reduce the emphasis on the overall health score

Keep the health score as a summary, but show underneath:

- What affected the score
- Which financial figures were used
- What is performing well
- What requires attention
- Whether important information is missing

6. Make alerts more actionable

Each alert should explain:

- What is happening
- When it is expected to happen
- What is causing it
- How serious it is
- What should be reviewed

- Alerts should help the advisor decide what to do next

7. Reduce duplication between sections

Give each section one clear purpose:

- Overview – summary of the financial position
- Cash Flow – monthly actuals, budget and forecast
- Performance – whole-farm and sector results
- Action Plan – alerts, recommendations and scenarios
- Farm Data – inputs, assumptions and supporting information

8. Make Farm Intelligence evidence-based

Structure each Farm Intelligence response around:

- Finding
 - Supporting evidence
 - Likely cause
 - Suggested action
 - Missing information or assumptions
- This would make its recommendations more reliable and easier for an advisor to justify.

9. Move advanced features later in the user journey

Place features such as Monte Carlo analysis, scenario comparison and investment-readiness reports within an “Advanced Analysis” section.

10. Improve the data-entry process

11. Standardise financial formatting

- Same number of decimal places
- Consistent percentage formatting
- Negative values shown consistently, such as –€12,500
- Consistent colours for positive, warning and critical results

12. Add data-quality warnings

Show a visible warning when:

- Information is outdated
- Required data is missing
- Figures do not reconcile
- Demo or estimated information is being used
- A forecast depends on incomplete assumptions

- Advisors need to know how reliable the information is before using

13. Show information progressively

Present the main conclusion first, followed by options to view:

- Monthly details
- Sector details
- Calculations
- Assumptions
- Source data

- Right now is too much information at once.